

3.3 Unit 3 PSYB3 Child Development and Applied Options

Students should have experience of designing and conducting informal classroom research using a variety of methods. They will be expected to analyse data collected in investigations and draw conclusions

based on research findings. They will be required to draw on these experiences to answer questions in the examination for this unit.

SECTION A CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Topics

3.3.1 Social Development
3.3.2 Cognitive Development
3.3.3 Moral Development

Aims

- To introduce students to additional topics in developmental psychology.
- To give students an understanding of methods used in developmental psychology.
- To provide students with knowledge of empirical research and its relationship to theory.
- To develop critical and evaluative skills in relation to theory and research in developmental psychology.
- To enable an appreciation of practical applications of theories and research.
- To develop an appreciation of how science works in developmental psychology.

3.3.1 Social Development

Early relationships

Attachment and the role of caregiver-infant interactions in the development of attachment, including reference to human and animal studies. Function of attachment. Secure and insecure attachments. Measuring attachment.

Possible short-term and long-term consequences of privation and deprivation.

Romanian orphan studies: effects of institutionalisation, age-related benefits of adoption (Rutter et al).

The work of Bowlby, Schaffer, Ainsworth and van Ijzendoorn.

Later Relationships

The development of friendship in childhood and adolescence. Age-related change in friendship. Sex differences in children's friendship. Research into the causes and consequences of popularity and rejection.

3.3.2 Cognitive Development

Piaget's theory of cognitive development

Schemas: adaptation, assimilation and accommodation. Piaget's stages of intellectual development. Characteristics of these stages, including object permanence, conservation, egocentrism, class inclusion. Piaget's research, including the three mountains experiment and conservation experiments.

Alternative approaches to children's cognition

Vygotsky and cognitive development within a social and cultural context. Vygotsky's zone of proximal development. Scaffolding. Guided participation in sociocultural activity.

Nativist explanations and early infant abilities, including knowledge of the physical world (Baillargeon).

The information processing approach: Siegler's research into problem solving strategies.

3.3.3 Moral development

Piaget and Kohlberg

Piaget's stages of moral development: premoral judgement, moral realism and moral relativism. Kohlberg's pre-conventional, conventional and post-conventional levels. The stages of moral reasoning within these levels.

Ways of investigating moral development including the use of moral comparisons and moral dilemmas.

Alternatives to Piaget and Kohlberg

Eisenberg's model of pro-social reasoning, including hedonistic, needs, approval, self-reflective and internalised orientations.

Gilligan's ethic of care: differences between boys and girls. Gilligan's three levels of moral development.

Damon's research into distributive justice.

Psychodynamic explanations of moral development. The role of the superego.

SECTION B APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY OPTIONS

Topics

3.3.4 Cognition and Law

3.3.5 Schizophrenia and Mood Disorders

3.3.6 Stress and Stress Management

3.3.7 Substance Abuse

3.3.8 Forensic Psychology

Aims

- To enable an understanding of how psychology is applied in the real world.
- To encourage appreciation of how psychological concepts, theories and research can be used to explain a variety of behaviours.
- To familiarise students with applied research in psychology.
- To develop an appreciation of how science works in applied psychology.

3.3.4 Cognition and Law

Recognising and remembering faces

Processes involved in recognition of faces. Explanations for face recognition, including feature analysis and holistic forms.

The construction of likenesses using composite systems.

Identification procedures: simultaneous and sequential line-ups.

Recalling events

Factors affecting the reliability of eye-witness accounts and eye-witness identification, including post-event contamination. Improving eye-witness recall, including features of the cognitive interview. Children as eye-witnesses. Flashbulb memory: memory for shocking events.

The false memory debate. Controversy surrounding the recovery of repressed memories. The existence of false memories. Evidence relating to repression and false memory. Ethical and theoretical implications of the false memory debate.

3.3.5 Schizophrenia and Mood Disorders

Classification of schizophrenia, including sub-types. Symptoms and diagnosis. Explanations, including biological and cognitive. Socio-cultural explanations: labelling and family dysfunction.

Treatments of schizophrenia, including anti-psychotic drugs, behavioural treatments and psychotherapy. The role of community care.

Evaluation of these treatments.

Mood Disorders

Unipolar and bipolar depression. Seasonal affective disorder (SAD). Symptoms and diagnosis of mood disorders. Explanations, including biological, cognitive, behavioural and psychodynamic.

Treatments of mood disorders, including biological and cognitive.

Evaluation of these treatments.

3.3.6 Stress and Stress Management

Stress and Illness

The role of the autonomic nervous system (ANS) and endocrine system functions in mediating and responding to stress.

Ways of measuring stress, including physiological, behavioural and self-report techniques.

The role of personal variables, including behaviour types A, B and C, locus of control and hardiness in mediating responses to stress.

Stress Management

Problem-focused and emotion-focused strategies. The role of defence mechanisms in coping with stress, including repression, regression, rationalisation and denial.

Techniques of stress management: behavioural approaches, including biofeedback and systematic desensitisation; cognitive therapy.

The role of social factors in coping with stress: social support, including types of social support.

3.3.7 Substance Abuse

Use and Abuse

Distinctions between addiction and physical dependence.

Psychological dependence, tolerance and withdrawal. Solvent abuse, tobacco and nicotine, alcohol, stimulants and depressants.

Explanations for substance abuse: hereditary factors; personality characteristics and social factors, including peer influences.

Treatment and Prevention

Psychological treatments and their effectiveness, including aversion therapy and self-management.

Prevention techniques. Identifying and targeting 'risk' groups. Use of fear-arousing appeals. Social inoculation.

Health promotion/education in treatment and prevention. The stages of behaviour change proposed in the Prochaska model.

3.3.8 Forensic Psychology

Offending Behaviour

Problems in defining crime. Measuring crime, including official statistics and alternatives (victim surveys and self-report measures). Offender profiling, including typology and geographical approaches.

Theories of offending. Physiological approaches: atavistic form and somatotype theories. Biological explanations, including genetic transmission. Psychodynamic and learning theory explanations, including social learning. Eysenck's theory of the criminal personality.

Treatment of Offenders

The role of custodial sentencing. Effectiveness of custodial sentencing, including recidivism. Alternatives to custodial sentencing.

Treatment programmes: behaviour modification; social skills training and anger management.

Evaluation of these treatment programmes.